

ISSUE NUMBER 01

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WINTER



**EAT RIGHT,
BE BRIGHT,
GROW STRONG!**



**Style
Spotlight**
featuring Jasmine Hodgson

Meet
**Ananya
Cleetus**

The girl with a day named
after her in Pittsburgh



*a
Girl's
Night Out*
Safety Tips
for the Sassy
Partygoer

**Sustainable
Fashion**
with Kimberley



Our Purpose

To be the voice for and from growing girls.

To create a safe space for young girls and women, to hear from other girls and women on their journeys, to understand how to deal with the pressures placed on them by peers, adults, the fashion and personal care industries.

To understand how to navigate a male dominated society.

To talk about subjects they feel too embarrassed or ashamed to raise.



A Voice for Girls

It all started with a cover of a magazine apparently written for YOU... miss tweens and teens, which showcased "miss beautiful", with her new denims, girl squads, ocean wave hair and lipstick, as if she slept in a princess bed and woke up with blue sparkly eyeshadow and pink lips and rouged cheeks. As if she never wondered if her friends liked her or if boys found her pretty, or if she was wearing the latest fashion, or if her skirt was stained, or if she would be judged for not having enough likes on insta, or if her calves were not the same size.

Well, that magazine cover was seen by a graphic artist... a mom and feminist like me, who was horrified at the message this magazine was sending to YOU, our future. That wonderful lady re-designed the cover to showcase a photo of a girl proud of her intellect and accomplishments, one who dreamed big and who didn't care if she belonged to the girl squad or not. When I saw the two covers side by side, I thought the mockup was a real magazine, speaking to real girls. But alas, it was just a cover. But.. but.. BUT...it was a wake up call, and it made me wonder if indeed there was such a magazine out there, and if not, why not?

And so **IMTAC — I'm More than a Cover** — was born.

Our vision for IMTAC is to empower and build a pipeline of future leaders, dreamers, artists, astronauts, scientists, doctors, singers, songwriters, vets, moms, stamp collectors, and yes, beauty queens too... just about anything you want to be. We want to be a safe space for you as you head into your most vulnerable years. We want you to hear from your sisters who have trodden that path and have some real life stories to share; to hear from girls who have chosen unlikely careers; and to talk about relationships, eating, depression, safety, with no judgement or pressure, because we've all been there.

We have some exciting topics in this, our first issue, but we want you to tell us if this matters to you and then tell us what you want to read about. Welcome and be empowered!



Deborah

IN THIS issue

No.1

IMTAC TEAM

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More
Than
A
Cover
Story

ON OUR COVER

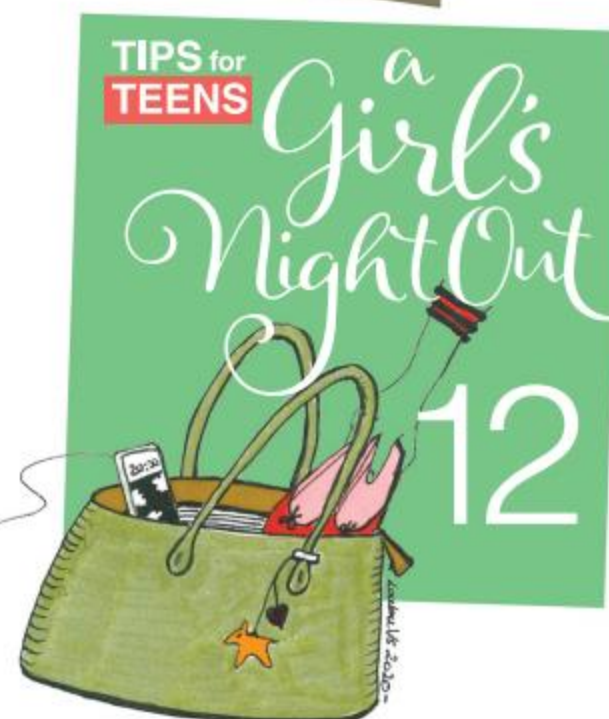


We are so proud to showcase and feature our first-ever "cover girl" to our readers! Read our interview with Ananya Cleetus on p.5!



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Style
Spotlight:
Jasmine
Hodgson



TIPS for
TEENS

a
Girl's
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*We want to
hear from you!*

If you have any questions, ideas, stories you want to share, people you want us to feature, or photos of your joy send them all to info@imtacmag.com

We'll collect all of them and have them published in the coming issues of IMTAC!

So keep sending in your questions, stories, and photos!

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Providing a Safe Space

An Interview with Ananya Cleetus

by Deborah Mannas

The Cover Girl of our very first issue has every right to say "I'm not Just a Cover". I talked over messenger with someone I knew as a baby in HK, until she moved to US at the age of 4. Ananya Cleetus developed her own low cost 3D-printed robotic prosthetic arm for leprosy victims in India, and has a day named after her in the city of Pittsburgh. She founded Anemone, a mental health crisis app for people in emergencies, and Magikstra, a Carnegie Science Award-winning social network for high school students to find mentors. In her free time, she make memes and pecan pies. Ananya is one of the youngest TEDx speakers, being only 22 when she gave her first talk. She currently studies Computer Science at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign and interns at Microsoft in Redmond. She teaches a freshman honors course, and helps run Reflections|Projections, the largest student-run technology conference in the Midwest.

This amazing young lady has battled being bipolar since her teens. I asked her to tell us her story.



Demonstrating her robotic prosthetic arm



Working on a counterfeit drug trafficking prevention project at CERN

Thanks so much for taking the time to talk to us and your passion for helping young girls. What or who were your earliest inspirations?

One of them was definitely my dad. He taught me how to build things around the house, tinker with tools, and really have my first experiences with engineering. Another big inspiration for me was science TV shows, especially Bill Nye and the Mythbusters. Even though each episode started with the classic "Do not try this at home" disclaimer, I always imagined myself being one of those people on TV: designing racecars, causing explosions, testing weird theories just for fun.

You are the quintessential third culture kid! Born in India, your first four years in Hong Kong, and then moving to Louisville, where you grew up! What were the biggest challenges you faced growing up?

I think one of the biggest challenges I faced growing up as a third culture kid was myself. In retrospect, I'm so lucky to have had such diverse childhood experiences and exposures to different cultures, but when you're in school trying to fit in, it doesn't feel like that sometimes. I sometime wondered why I was different: why I spoke different languages, why I knew the

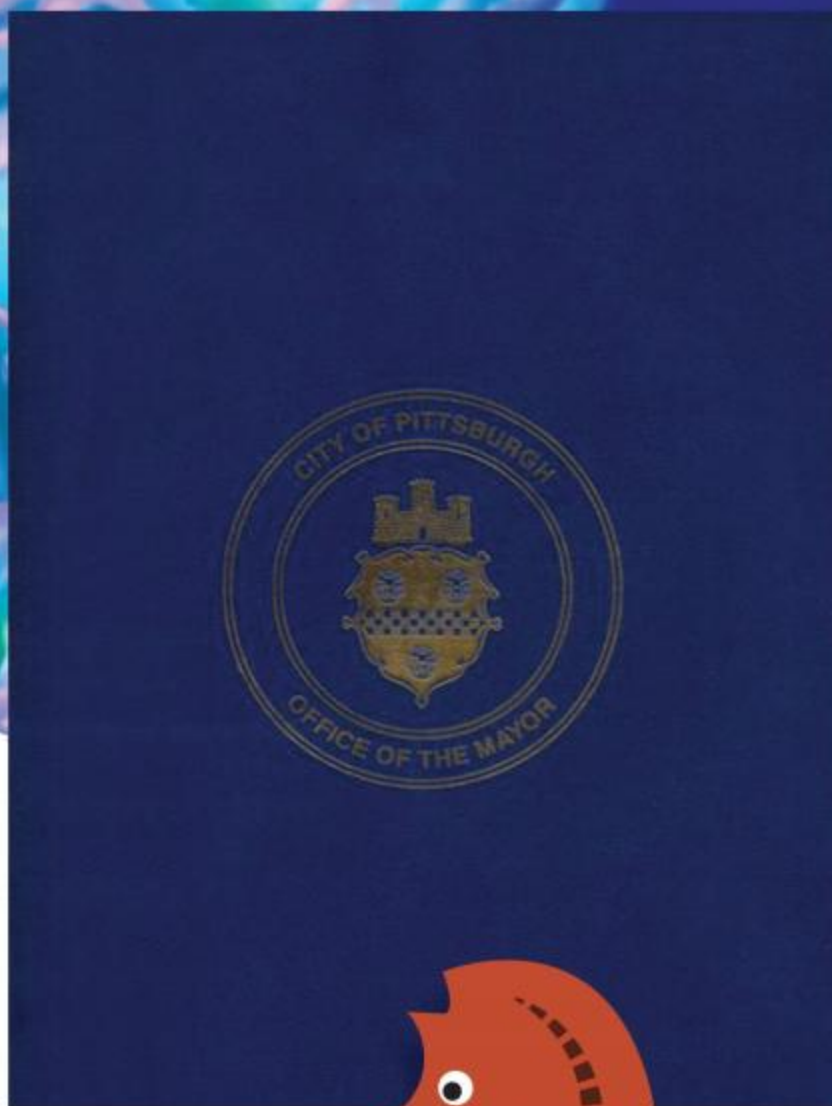
names of different dishes others hadn't heard of, why our car played different music in the school carpool line. At first, I felt that those differences isolated me, but now I've realized that the cultural background is such a core part of my identity.



Receiving the Carnegie Science Award for Start-Up Entrepreneur

How did you deal with them? What support system did you have?

I think the person who really stands out to me is my sister. Despite the fact that she's younger than



"Ananya Cleetus Day" Proclamation from Mayor of Pittsburgh



me, she is definitely wiser and one of the most supportive and thoughtful people I've ever met. Since we moved around a lot earlier in my childhood, she and I got very close just through dealing with some of the changes

What did you find most difficult to talk about as a teenager?

My mental health. As a kid growing up, I was never really taught about mental health or illness through school and most definitely not at home in my Desi family, so it was something I sort of figured out on my own initially. I struggled with depression and general mental health for a big part of my life and never quite knew how to reach out for help. It was a generally taboo subject at home, and at school, a lot of friends didn't know how to

help or how to react so more often than not, they would just ignore it or distance themselves. For a long time, I blamed myself for feeling different, struggling to stay focused in school, or even having difficulty getting out of bed. I knew a little bit about mental health but still could never figure out what felt so strange. I finally started receiving therapy towards the end of high school, but it took some time for me (and my family) to really understand the gravity of what I was experiencing. It wasn't until I came to college actually that I got my current diagnosis of bipolar disorder. I also learned in college that this was actually a fairly common experience, especially around mental health in South Asian families and other Asian cultures. There

was an interesting quote I read later on that I think phrases it best: "Depression is like sex. Indian parents think their kids don't have it". While the quote itself definitely makes me laugh, it's also a reminder that something like mental health continues to be stigmatized even more than classic teenage taboos like drinking, partying, and premarital sex.

What made you come up with Anemone and why that name?

Around my junior year of college, my mental health started to seriously decline. I didn't have a proper diagnosis or medical care at that point and felt too scared to talk to my family, so it all spiraled downwards for me very quickly. I ended up being hospitalized many times during that year and it became a sort of vicious

Screenshots of
Ananya's Anemone Crisis App



Breathe

 **anemone**

Get Started

cycle. I ended up having to leave school to take a medical withdrawal for a few years, and during my time off, I had a lot of time to think about my own experiences and traumas from college. I realized that just like me, most people don't know how to respond to a mental health crisis. As kids, we're all taught about emergency responses, but they all relate to physical emergencies. If you ask people what to do in a mental health emergency, most adults won't even know what to say, so how are teenagers and young adults supposed to navigate these situations? This realization led me to create Anemone, which is a free mental health crisis mobile app that allows users to prepare and respond to mental health emergencies with a fully customizable crisis plan they can share with friends, family, mental health professionals, and first responders. They

also have easy access to emergency resources based on their location, as well as national resources and personal contacts. The app also includes popular therapy skills from cognitive behavioral therapy and dialectical behavioral therapy, and a virtual grounding box. The name Anemone actually initially came to mind from the scene in "Finding Nemo", but I think it's very apt because sea anemones in the ocean provide a safe space for fish and other creatures to hide and lay their eggs. My app does the same thing for

"I think an underlying theme that connects all those different sorts of people is compassion"



ane

people and allows them to have a safe space in their phone, no matter where they are.

How long did it take you to create it - from concept to launch?

The app took half a year to create it, from starting with the original idea, research and talking to psychiatrists and therapists, developing the art and design style, coding it, to finally launching it on the App Store.

What were the initial reactions when you first launched Anemone?

The initial responses were amazing. When I launched the app, I also decided to share the motivation behind it and my own experiences, with friends and family. I received such an outpouring of support for both Anemone and from sharing my own story. I also was happy to see that a lot of people loved the concept and felt it was such an important problem. While the mental health tech space is growing now, there are not many apps that focus specifically on crises, partly due to how difficult a subject it is to broach. Many people reached out to me on social media as well to share their own experiences with mental health.

How did you influence people to support you?

This one is hard sometimes, especially growing up in a community that would often prefer to sweep mental health issues under the rug. One thing I've learned is everyone is in a different place with how they feel about mental health. Some people are more vocal about their struggles or actively involved in treatment or advocacy. Others care about mental wellbeing in a more holistic sense but don't want to talk about mental illness or crisis situations. And then there are people who refuse to hear it at all, often due to social pressures, stigma, fear, guilt, or even a lack of information. I think an underlying theme that connects all those different sorts of people is compassion though. Everyone may not exhibit it themselves but everyone can understand what it means to be compassionate. So that's often something I focus on when working on mental health advocacy on my school campus or even my app. Whether it's a professor understanding that students are stressed about an exam, a friend realizing that their classmate hasn't been sleeping well lately, or even self-compassion, it's an idea a lot of

people are willing to rally around and work on.

You did your first TEDx talk at 22!! How did you feel? How did you prepare?

I was terrified to be speaking on a stage in front of hundreds of people, but there was also an indescribable feeling of relief almost when I was able to finally speak in public about my mental health journey. It's been difficult to come to terms with my own struggles with mental health, but being able to say it out loud was a huge first step for me.



Have you ever experienced self doubt? If so, what techniques do you use to overcome them and achieve so much?

I have definitely experienced self-doubt, and for me, a lot of the doubt is related to how I see myself doing in the world. Even though everyone talks about how important it is to be able to focus on your own success, that's a very difficult thing to do. Especially in the world of social media where every new dance move or loaf of bread you share is instantly subjected to likes, comments, and other comparative metrics, it's hard to tune everyone else out. That same comparison can be helpful though when you realize how fake the world of social media actually is. People post

their “highlight reels” for the world but don’t talk publicly about their failures, struggles, and fears. When I feel self-doubt, it’s often because I’m comparing my challenges to someone else’s curated Instagram feed. It’s important

to realize that we’re our own harshest critics and will never get a full picture of anyone else’s life but our own. It’s easy to dwell in your own doubts sometimes when you can only see others’ good moments and not their own struggles.

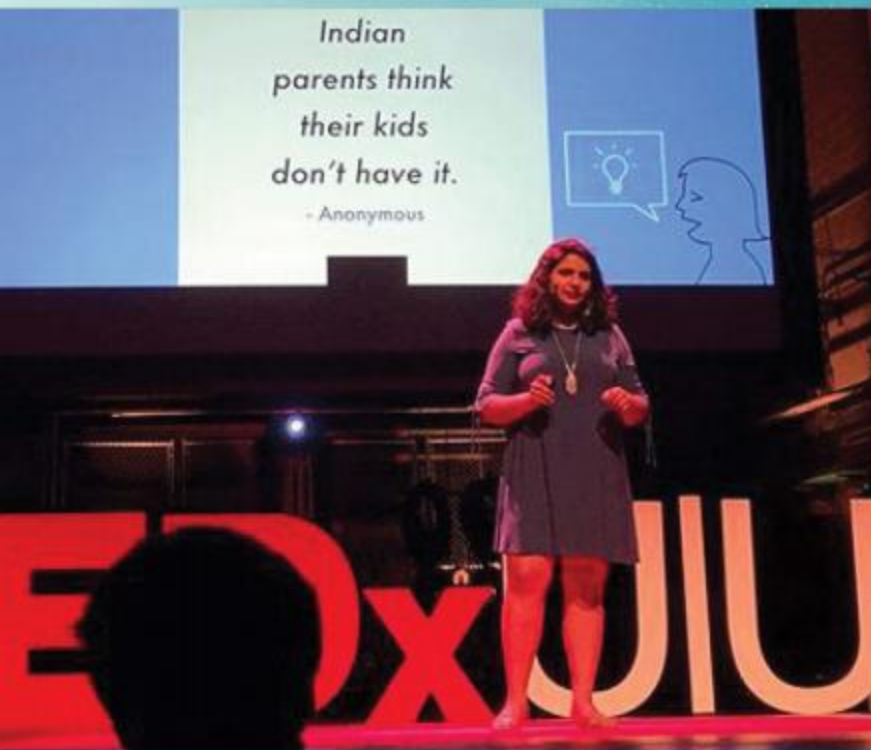
What advice would you give to girls who are struggling to understand what the future holds for them?

I would say, don’t be afraid to try things out. You will never understand a new field or realize a new passion unless you actually try those things first. It’s hard sometimes to want to explore when there’s

so much pressure to follow a traditional life trajectory and have instant success, but don’t let those nagging interests or dreams remain unexplored. It’s important to find what you love, even if it means trying 10 other things. Especially as girls, there’s sometimes pressure to follow the same typical career path or focus on the same subjects, but please don’t be scared to choose something new. Worst case scenario: you’ve wasted some time, best case scenario: you’ve found your true calling.

What advice would you give to girls who are struggling to cope with the myriad pressures and challenges that girls face from every direction?

Remember to take care of yourself first. As girls, there will always be so many challenges and pressures from others, some of which we’re taught to take in stride. Many of us are also taught to prioritize others and



Talking about mental health in Indian families

be a caretaker or support to others. Self-compassion and self-love are honestly so important though and even more so now with everything that’s going on in the world. There’s no shame in taking care of yourself or letting yourself rest. It’s sort of like the safety training you hear on airplanes about oxygen masks. You have to help yourself before you can assist others.

What would you say to your teenage self, looking back 10 years?

I would tell myself that I’m not actually alone, even though it seems like it. Mental illness by nature is such an isolating issue sometimes, and especially in the Indian community, I always felt like I was alone. It was only when I came to college that I realized that there were so many people in my shoes, who also all feel alone.

If you had a vision for girls the world over, what would it be?

I would love to see more girls involved in starting projects and companies and getting resources and funding for their ideas. Girls have the potential to create so many new inventions, resources, and projects to help their communities and the world, but it makes me sad to see that such a small percentage of money and support go to girl-led initiatives all over the globe. | #IMTAC



Left: Ananya with Mythbusters host, Kari Byron; Above: Waiting for President Obama at the White House Science Fair; Below left: Presenting at UIUC's Cozad New Venture Challenge; Below right: Ananya with United States CTO, Megan Smith



Thank you so much Ananya! I'd love to see you back as a contributor for IMTAC, and am sharing some of your links for our readers...

Check out these links if you want to learn more about Ananya, her app Anemone, or listen to her TedTalk!

<http://www.anemoneapp.io/>

TEDx Talk

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j5uVK2EDhhU>

Carnegie Science Awards

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zld41ol9DTU>

TIPS for
TEENS

a Girl's Night Out

**Safety Tips for the
Sassy Partygoer**

by Loulou Von Spiel

I started going out when I was 15. At that time, we had no mobile phones, no internet, no Uber, but on the up side, you could enter any club without an ID.

Things have evolved since I was a teen, and in 2020, it has never been easier to enjoy a night out safely, thanks to all our current technology, and yet, there is still room for vigilance, as when it comes to ill-intentioned people, they will wait for your guards to be down to strike. So IMTAC, has compiled a list of steps you can take to make your night out as stress-free as possible, for yourself and those around you.



Being prepared is everything!

Get that handbag ready...

Now let your parents, flatmates or friends know where you are heading, who with, and provide relevant contact numbers and addresses (club, friends, location etc.), work out your app settings if you use one...



You're all set, but how are you getting there and back?

Short of a carriage made out of a pumpkin, make sure you know if you'll be using public transport, taxi or your own car. If within walking distance, simply put on shoes you can easily walk in and change at the destination if necessary.

CHOOSE IN ADVANCE

How you will be returning home? Take note of all info such as taxi stand/bus stop location, Uber number, last trains time table or making sure whoever is driving home remains sober!

IF YOU ARE WALKING...

Be extra vigilant, focus on where you are going, hold on to your handbag, and don't appear lost, GPS is your friend!

at the Party

You're there, your friends are around, as well as a multitude of strangers and you may want to meet new people, so how will you know friends from foes?

FAMILIAR FACES

Look around to identify people you know or trust (if out alone) and stick with them. If some people make you feel uneasy, get away from them.

FEELING UNWELL

If you feel unwell at any moment, tell your friends, doorman, even the bar staff. **DO NOT follow strangers** if you are not feeling in control.

FRIENDS RULE

When out with female friends, always check on each other at regular intervals. Listen to their opinion if they are concerned about you, and voice your own if you feel uncomfortable with their behaviour.

VISIBILITY

If a man or boy you don't know approaches you, stay in plain view. If you separate from your friends to have a quiet chat somewhere, let them know beforehand.

Going back home

First and foremost, try to not overdo it with the drinks, especially if you are by yourself. Know your limit. Being carried out of a nightclub covered in vomit is never a cool look!

MESSAGE your parents or flatmates

to let them know you are on your way, you can use some apps to do so. Later, let your friends know you are home safe!

BUS

If alone, sit by the driver, ask them to remind you of your stop if you feel you may fall asleep. Stay away from inebriated or boisterous passengers, remain on the lower deck on a double-decker bus.

TRAIN

Catching the last train? No worries, there will be many people doing the same and it will be "safety in numbers". Favour a carriage with many women.

TAXI

Usually safe, but keep your wits about to dodge any potential abuse or scam. Uber (or similar) may be the safest option.



JUST SAY "NO"

Learn to refuse drinks, drugs, kisses or cuddling in a dark corner. If your heart is not in it, stay away and do not give in to peer pressure.

DRINK SAFELY!

If someone offers you a drink, be sure to see it being prepared at the bar, do not accept it out of nowhere.

BELONGINGS

Don't leave them laying around while clubbing, and if it is valuable, keep it on you, or put it in the cloakroom. Fun anecdote, I once lost a unique jacket in a club and a week later, caught up with a girl wearing it in the Ladies of the same venue! After confronting her, I got my precious item back!

Keep your drink with you at all time, or in your sight. Someone could steal it or worse, spike it! From hallucinogenic drug to GHB "the rape drug", it is easy to miss someone dropping something into your glass, so don't risk it. Sad fact: such deeds may come from people belonging to your circles.



WALKING HOME (alone or as a pair)

While sexual attacks may be your biggest fear, you are realistically more likely to have your handbag rather than your body, targeted by a stranger.

Carrying an umbrella is known to deter most muggers, and my personal favourite, "Silly walking". As a night owl for decades, I always felt confident that appearing demented would probably deter anyone from wanting to approach me.

A small pocket knife or an improvised weapon, such as a key, sharp keyring or your mobile ready to call emergency, can work well. Although not legal everywhere, a pepper spray is efficient, or a high-pitched emitting device able to pierce the eardrum of an attacker if triggered in their ear

WORST-CASE SCENARIO

DO YOU KNOW KUNG FU?

Never mind, a knee in the groin will do the trick. Joke aside, self defense and martial arts can really come in handy so check out your local BJJ, Krav Maga or Thai boxing classes.

We hope these tips keep you safe, and make your experience of a night on the town more pleasant.

Remember that drinking sensibly, using common sense and keeping your loved ones aware of your whereabouts are all essential, but ultimately, your instinct is always your best ally. If it doesn't feel right, it probably isn't. | #IMTAC



Sustainable Styling?

by Kimberley Kleczka

An invitation arrived at Susan's house; her best friend was having a high school graduation party. But unfortunately, she did not have a lot of money to spend on a new outfit at the mall. She was devastated, until one of her friends had a great suggestion, about checking out the second-hand vintage shops that were local to her.

Susan stepped up on the wooden step, paused and looked up at the shop window, peering back at her was a fashionably dressed mannequin, wearing a textured black and red mini skirt, cool Baby Doll t-shirt, a funky black felt cloche hat accessorizing with black rocker boots. With trepidation she opened the shop door, not knowing what she would find inside. A delight it was indeed! Fun clothes, great accessories, shoes, boots and at the prices she could not

believe and could certainly afford. This was her first experience in a vintage secondhand shop. Yes, you guessed correctly, Susan was sold and has never looked back. Over the years I too have found many treasures that have personally been added to my wardrobe. Love swapping out clothes and accessories with friends and family.

Sustainable styling has been around for more than thirty plus years, emerging from several different movements, the hippie, the punk, eco fashion, that lead into today's fair trade and sustainable fashion. The main three things that you should focus on in the fashion Industry is what impact does your clothes have on animals, is the designer thinking about not using animal hair, leather and fur. Are people being paid fair wages. What about the environment and the distance of where the

fashion is being produced and where are the factories? How transparent is this commercial enterprise about being ethical with fair trade and is it reducing carbon footprint? Did you know that 10-15 percent of all fast fashions are sold, and the rest is never used? One has to take many different factors into consideration if you want to support sustainable fashion. The meaning of the concept is the buying, recycling, reusing, shopping at vintage and secondhand shops. There are amazing pieces that you can pick up at these wonderful shops. Why not shop at your local boutiques and favourite couturiers?

There are many grass root designers, that would love your support. It would be so amazing and brilliant if more designers started creating their pieces of art by re-using existing materials.

As a person that likes to shop until they drop, I have become a conscious shopper. Have tried

to combine sustainable fashions into my lifestyle by changing up my wardrobe. It is great fun upcycling your clothes, turning them into a new look. Invite your mates around to have a fun day giving your old clothes a second life.



Let's do a challenge together for the next four months. It is called the No New Clothing Challenge. No buying new clothes for the duration of the year. Except for your lingerie, we all need new bras and panties. You can wear all the clothes in your closet, create some fab styles, try to buy second hand and you can exchange your clothes with friends, family and strangers if you like their look. Have a blast upcycle your outfits. If you buy anything, tell us why, where and what motivated you. Let's share each other's styling journey with photographs and your own personal clothing challenge.

It is important to do something small every day to help the world! | #IMTAC



Kimberley Kleczka's Style Watch is a segment about educating our readers about personality style, sustainability, beauty and beauty products, style your room as well as hearing about your personal style stories and faux pas. Kimberley will be chatting with couturiers and décor designers, Artists, different experts and influencers.



Style Spotlight

**Kimberley Chats with
Jasmine Hodgson**

Who Is Jasmine Hodgson?

I'm 19, I'm half English half Chinese. Things that are important to me: sustainability, design and my dogs

Where and what are you studying?

I'm currently studying architecture at the University of Bath. I've loved architecture

since I was really young and really hope to be able to develop sustainable architecture around Asia in the future.

How long have you been living in Hong Kong?

I've been living in Hong Kong since I was born. Although I spend quite a bit of time in the UK now as I study there, I still consider Hong Kong to be my home :)

What is your style in clothing?

I would say my style is quite casual. I normally wear t-shirts and shorts/ jeans but occasionally try out different styles when I'm feeling creative.

Do you like second hand and vintage shops?

I do! I particularly love the charity shops in the UK because it's a three in one-you can get good quality second-hand clothing, for a good price all while supporting a good cause! A couple of years ago I got a vintage Guinness t-shirt which I love because it's very unique and I have no idea where I would otherwise be able to buy one.

Have you tried swapping clothes with friends?

Swapped not so much-but one of my friends gave me a huge bag of clothes after she changed her style as she thought some of her clothes would suit me (which was very sweet of her). She gave me a couple of things that I typically wouldn't have normally considered wearing but I tried them and actually wear them quite a bit now! My sister also has a habit of raiding my closet and stealing my clothes haha!

Do you have any favourite brands?

As a big believer in sustainability, I try not to buy clothes too often and only allow myself to buy something if I really, really love it and know I can wear it for a long time. Because of this, I've collected clothes from an assortment of branded and local shops over the years. I'm trying to move away from fast fashion brands because of their negative impact on the environment and am instead trying to buy from shops that produce better quality, longer lasting and more consciously produced clothing (like Tove and Libra!). I'm also a huge fan of Uniqlo's heat techs because I'm rubbish with the cold.

What does sustainability mean to you?

Sustainability refers to consumption in a way that allows us to continue to do so in the future. People typically associate sustainability with environmental sustainability – using planet-friendly materials and buying things that are reusable and last longer, but it's so much more than that! Sustainability also covers economic and social aspects, so supporting local businesses also is a very important part of sustainability. | #IMTAC

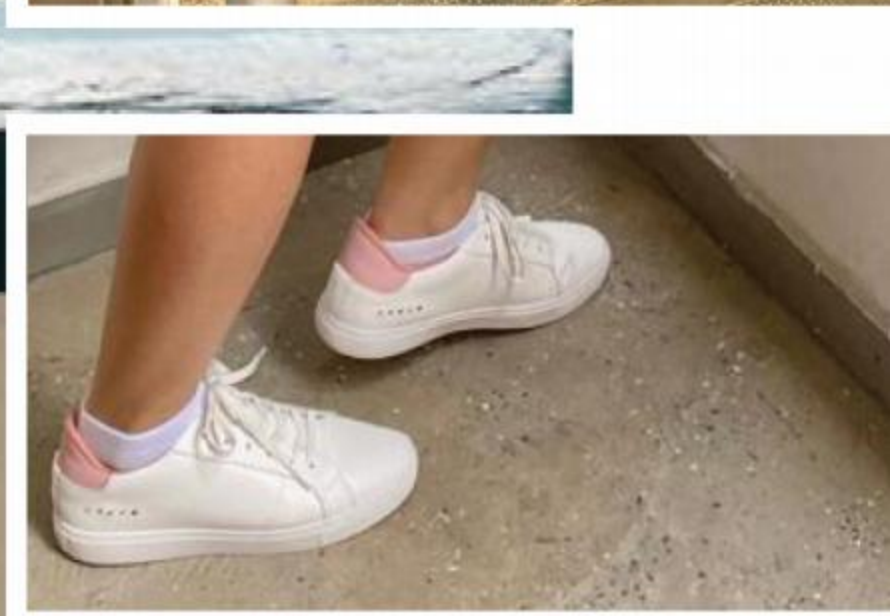


Jasmine is wearing a fun knit dress, that is made from a collection of left-over yarns, to create the two mix and match combos. This comfortable knit dress is 100 percent cotton and is a pull on with no zippers and great to wear on any occasion.

“

As a big believer in sustainability, I try not to buy clothes too often and only allow myself to buy something if I really, really love it and know I can wear it for a long time.

”



The white trainers are made from waste, a combination of recycled bottles and leather. The rubber on the bottom of the shoe and the shoelaces are also recyclable. Lining is also made of sustainable material. Laces donates a portion of the proceeds to compassion first. They are using the money to help fight sex trafficking around South East Asia.



White pants-pull on slim china. Have a slimming touch without being super tight. These pants are cotton, nylon stretch. They have an elastic waist with pockets. They're light and breathable, so you can wear them all year round.



Blue knit top is cotton and silk blend. It is made from natural fibres and is naturally breathable. It is a modern classic with a little edge with the knit pointelle on the top of this lovely piece. You can tuck this top in or out, depends on the look you want to create.

Fun cute skirt made of rayon and nylon blend. This is a nice cool touch, as it is upcycled from other designers left over materials.



Tove & Libra have been in the fashion industry for three generations, watching the lifecycle of fashion products get shorter and dirtier.

In 2018, they finally decided to leverage this heritage and experience into their own collection of expertly made womenswear. Their brand is built on quality over quantity, which is better for the wardrobe, the wallet and the planet.

They own their sourcing and production facilities, which ensure fair practices and lean pricing.

They have insider access to deadstock materials from other designers' production, which are then upcycle into their own designs.

Thoughtful Design: Each line and stitch are designed to ensure style longevity and ease of wear, so that their clothes spend more time out of your closet than it.

Feel-Good Materials: Their carefully selected materials are kind on your skin while also being kind to the planet. They're easy to care for and either sustainably produced or saved from landfill.

Fair Practices: Their family-owned sourcing and production facilities ensure ethics and sustainability goals are achieved to the highest standards with the greatest pride.

Health, Nutrition, and You

by Denise Patel

So who do we consider to be "healthy?" From an "older" person's perspective, someone who is mentally, physically and emotionally well, makes good choices and decisions that impact their health and wellbeing. So it would be wise to say we are responsible to create a healthy space for ourselves! No matter what our background or upbringing, we are all interested in food.

We often express love through food, when mum cooks you her special meal, you know it's made with love and it's good for you. Most reality TV shows these days are based on food and while some of us are trying to be master chefs cooking an impressive meal for family or friends, others are happy to sit back and be spoilt. The food we eat is a big part of who we are, from festive celebrations to after school or college catch ups, the focus is always on glorious yummy food!

Interview with Alana

I decided to get a teen view on food and diet, so I spoke to "supergirl" Alana, 14 years old, goes to a local Sydney Girls School, enjoys cooking, her favourite meal is lasagne. She also plays Netball twice a week and coaches a junior football team, "supergirl" lives only a

few streets away from us. Her occasional treats are Aporto burgers or fish and chips, sometimes ice cream.

So I asked her, "do girls your age discuss diet and food?" she said "yes, most girls my age are very conscious about their bodies, they tend to eat less but suddenly crave junk food" She told me about "girls who are scared to eat in case they become overweight" in fact "there is one girl in particular who refuses to eat all day, when we share food, she takes a little and nibbles on it!" so I asked her "does she weigh herself every day?" "Yes, she does that often!" To me this is a warning sign, this can lead to serious eating disorders that require counselling and support from family and friends. In Nutrition we label this a "yellow flag", it means that we treat this with caution, it needs urgent attention. During this exciting

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life stage of growth
and development, your bodies
are changing, your minds are trying
to keep up with changing trends
on social media, peer pressure,
slim models and actors
wearing size 0 clothing, so
the choices we make during
this demanding time determine
how we see ourselves as healthy
individuals of the future. So we
need to teach ourselves to eat
for nourishment, while also having a
bit of fun exploring various food sources,
essential nutrients and sampling recipes.

Food composition

The three macronutrients Carbohydrates,
Protein and Fats make up a well-balanced
meal, they fuel our bodies on any given day.
Lacking in any of these nutrients, result in
depleted energy, poor cognition and focus,
and if not addressed could end in chronic
illness. Most of the carbohydrates comes
from rice, breads, cereals and grains; protein
from our meat, fish, poultry or legumes; fats
from our fatty fish, nuts, oils and seeds. No
matter how varied out menus, diets, styles
of cooking, culture and religion, a meal will
be a combination of these major nutrients.
While the quality of food is important, the

quantity is just as important, this will depend
upon your energy requirements and your
level of physical activity. We also need to
consider how we eat, taking time to sit down
and enjoying a meal with loved ones or
friends is crucial to how we digest food.

So come along on the nutrition journey, we
can share healthy recipes and food/exercise
apps, discuss diet and lifestyle concerns.
My role as nutritionist is not to advise you
on what or how much to eat, but to offer you
guidance and the tools necessary to make
the right food choices, because what you
eat in your teen years greatly impacts on
your long term health and vitality. | #IMTAC

It's been many years since school, but I still remember how I felt before I attended subjects I loved ... my heart would go faster and my step would be lighter. I remember feeling buoyed up, joyful and completely engrossed before, during and after. But I imagine I know how Harry Potter felt when the dementors sucked the soul from him, during subjects I hated. I was lucky to have owned these feelings very early on. My dad, an engineer, was disappointed I didn't want to be an engineer like him, but I felt very strongly that my calling was with people, music, humanities. And so I switched degrees to Psychology, English Literature and Sociology. I've never looked back. Today, I use all of my learning... in Human Resources, Poetry Writing, and Music. I was lucky... I found my joy! It took a while, but I got there. This joy has allowed me to connect with like minded people, and find applications in so very many areas.

Have you ever not done stuff you didn't like? How much time did you spend either covering up, redoing it, and doing it anyway, but on your weekends. Did the results of a rush job bring joy? I guess the point I'm trying to make is, gravitate towards the things that give you JOY! And you will feel more motivated to do the things you don't like, so you can focus on what uplifts you.

Once you master that, you don't have to deal with constant stress about NOT doing boring stuff, and can get on with all the stuff you find fun. Not doing the boring stuff means that's all you'll be doing, you'll stress out about it and you won't sleep well, which will trigger a host of other issues. Give yourself a reason. Find Your Joy!

What was something you thought was not fun, and then it turned out to be a great experience when you did it, which led to many more fun experiences? I'm sure our readers would love to know.

by Deborah Mannas



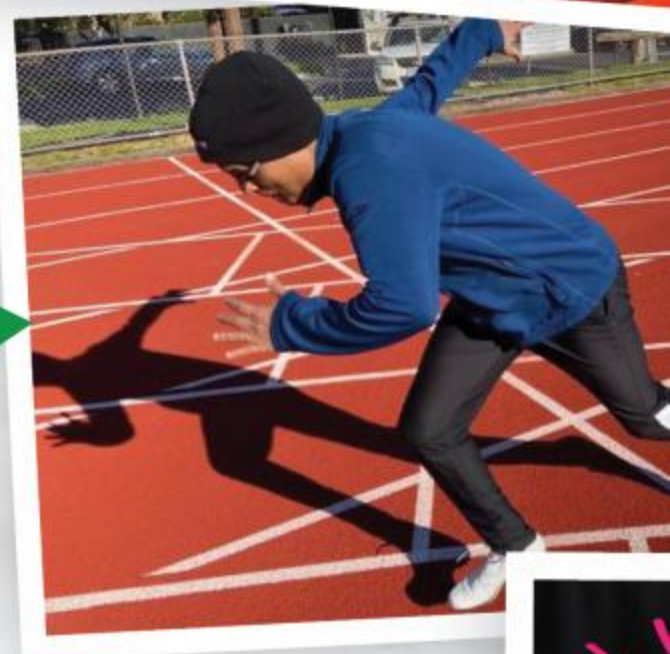
*My joy is dogs, board games, pasta, organisation and good design! | **Jasmine***

My joy is making people happy and putting smiles on their faces through being an author, radio host and publicity peace ambassador.

Kimberley



*I love to run. Sprinting and coaching my athletes to move functionally is an absolute joy for me | **Duane***



*It was the most joyful moment of my life - having a dessert with the man of my life on our wedding day. We were laughing so hard because it was the first thing we ate after hours of standing, walking, greeting and shooting photographs on a sunny day. | **Ceci***



We asked the IMTAC team the question: "What brings you joy?"
This is what they told us...

Find your Joy



Playing my favorite video game or cycling on my halfbike would be my personal joys! | **Q**



I find joy in painting and drawing, but also decorating my home and staying at places that have put efforts into such details. Here I am doing a mural at a friend's art centre in Penang, Malaysia. | **Loulou**

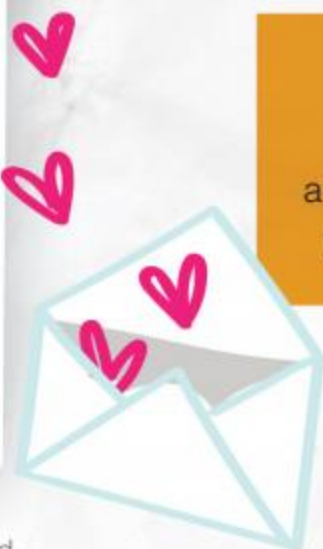


My joy is singing and songwriting! Here I am at the launch of my first album, *Inspired* | **Debbie**



What gives you joy?

Send us a photo with a short description and we'll add them into our wall of joy! Send your contributions to info@imtacmag.com



Do you have questions that you're too embarrassed to ask? Is there a topic or story that you want to share but find it awkward to talk to others about? Ceci is here to discuss and try to answer all your questions about life, friendship, family, relationships, and growing up. She is the big sister that you can always ask questions to! Here are a few questions she's answered, from our readers...



Hi Ceci! I have a new friend. I really like her. We get on well, and have similar interests. But my mum doesn't like her as she is not from a good enough background. How do I get my mum to let us hang out together?
- Julia :)

Hi Julia, everyone of us has no way to determine our background but we have every way to determine how we would like to live our lives to the full. I suggest you talk to your mom about how your friend shares similar interests with you, how you may influence each other in a good way and what both of you have been doing or are planning to do to cultivate your interests together. When you mom sees how positive this friendship is, I'm sure she will gradually change her mind.

Hi Ceci! My friends all wear really short skirts and cami tops, but I'm not comfortable wearing those. I'm self conscious and afraid I'll be judged. At the same time, I get teased for being too

covered up. Please help!
- Self-consciousGal

Dear Self-consciousGal, my suggestion is for you to dress in a way that makes you happy. We are not dolls who should look exactly the same. A true beauty is someone who discovers his/her



own uniqueness and is confident enough to live according to it. If you feel happy putting on short skirts and cami tops, do so. If you feel happy covering up more, it is fine too. First of all, reflect upon yourself and identify who you are and what you like. Then, choose an outfit that suits you. Last but not the least, be confident and happy about your look. If your uniqueness is the

source of your charm, the finishing touch is the confident smile on your face when you interact with other people.

Dear Ceci, now that we are studying from home, sometimes my camera is on; I'm not from a rich family and when my classmates see my background they make fun of me. How can I deal with this?
- Homeschooler

Hello Homeschooler, studying from home is a new experience for a lot of us and we need some time to adjust to the changes. As we try to get used to it, the most important thing is to remember why this has started in the first place - to help us acquire knowledge in a safe and efficient way. To achieve this, we have to create a suitable learning environment for ourselves. Make sure you





have
a
good
light
source, a
neat space for

writing and a computer with stable internet connection. If you have secured all these, you are as competent as any of your fellow classmates in an online class. Indeed, when your camera is on, people may see a small part of your home. However, we do not turn on our camera to compete for the most expensive house, we do so for our teachers to check our learning progress. I suggest you ignore the irrelevant things other people say and stay focused during class to gain knowledge. You will discover knowledge is more precious than gold and silver.

*Hi Ceci! I just started at a new school that I really like. But I'm so lonely. I do not have a single close friend from my grade. I try to be friendly with loads of people, but I still am eating lunch by myself every day. I feel awkward sitting at other tables. I desperately need your advise. - **Lonely Luncher***

Hi Lonely Luncher, this is indeed a situation that most of us encounter when we move to a new environment. What do you like about the new school? I would love to hear more about that next time. A good way to start making friends is to find someone who shares similar interests with you. Does your school have any clubs? If they do, you may try signing up for a club and making friends with club members. It will be easier to start a conversation with them, join their activities and have lunch when you have common interests. Aside from clubs, you may also volunteer in sports events or cultural events at school to meet people and make friends in a natural way.

*Dear Ceci, I have a classmate that I've known from primary, he's one of my dearest friends, and everyone assumes we're together. I know he likes me, but I like another older boy. I don't want to hurt my friend. What should I do? - **Friendzoned***

Hi Friendzoned! First of all, it may be better for you to draw a line between a friend and a boyfriend within your heart. Then, you may try to reflect upon the relationship between you and your friend to check if you may have crossed

the line without knowing it. If you are sure about your feelings, it will be best to protect your precious relationship by keeping distance within the line and never cross it even if he tries to. Whenever possible, you may also talk with him and express how much you treasure him as your friend. Normally, if you do so, he will understand how you want your relationship to develop in the future.



Cecilia Ao or Ceci is a lifelong learner who enjoys exploring life through the lens of Psychology, History and Philosophy. She fancies moments of silence in a starry night when she writes her thoughts in a journal. She also loves hanging out with friends in daytime to listen to their adventures and exchange ideas with them. If you want a new friend, she is ready to listen to your stories over a cup of coffee. She will savour the taste of life with you and offer a "peace" of cake. | #IMTAC

Got questions for Ceci?

Send her an email at askceci@imtacmag.com If you're feeling shy, let us know in your email and we could still publish an answer under a different name. We collect all of the questions and try to publish as many of them as we can, so keep them coming!

the IMTAC fam



Deborah Mannas is an HR leader, a singer/songwriter/poet, a mother and a D&I crusader. She has BA in Psychology, Sociology and Literature, and an MSc in Training and HR Management. Deborah has spent years building new generations of inclusive leaders and shares her journey at conferences, radio and TV. Deborah has two original solo albums, #DeborahMagician (2019) and #DeborahInspired (2018), plus two singles in 2020 so far.

Deborah

Kimberley

Kimberley Kleczka is a couturier of women's scarves and arties, author, storytelling master, songwriter, presenter and voice animator for children's books, commercials and documentaries. Kimberley hosts a radio daytime show in Hong Kong, which features Kimberley Kleczka's Style Watch and Helping Hands, amazing stories from incredible people in Hong Kong and globally.



French writer, artist and illustrator, **Loulou Von Spiel** moved to London at 20. Following years of clubbing and style exploration, she started her own club-nights, DJ-ing and promoting bands for years. An avid Asian cinema lover, she relocated to HK, and enjoys a quiet existence with her dog and turtles. She has contributed to several magazines and is currently writing a vegan storybook for children.

Loulou

Quincy

Quincy Gonzales or Q is a passionate creative. He has been working as a designer for the last two decades focusing heavily in branding, publications, post-production, and everything in between. Q loves video games and watching shows on Netflix and Youtube. He lives in Hong Kong with his lovely wife and adorable puppy, Kimmy.



Duane Girton's 35 years of experience has spanned a variety of roles. From a financial adviser to a high-performance athletics coach, entrepreneur to a certified Holistic Wellness practitioner. He brings his business & marketing knowledge to the IMTAC team. His daughter is his inspiration towards IMTAC's purpose. Duane believes he is a life long learner and is an athlete in training for the 100mtr Sprint. His passion for self-development is his driving force.

Duane



in the next issue....

- **Socially-conscious young entrepreneurs**
- **Empowerment through sports**
- **Pushing for your passion**
- **A young man's perspective on respect**
- **Women in male dominated industries**
- **And more!**

We are always looking for contributors! If you're an aspiring writer, illustrator, or artist and you want to have a go at being part of upcoming issues, let us know! Drop us an email at info@imtacmag.com with the subject "I want to contribute!"

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